



7th Grade English Language Arts: Teacher Manual

M/J LANGUAGE ARTS 2 · FLORIDA COURSE #1001040 · 2026–2027



FACILITATOR COPY. CONTAINS ANSWER KEYS AND GRADING GUIDANCE.

Do not publish to students. This document is not part of the student-facing course and should never be linked from a Canvas page, module, or syllabus students can see.

COURSE

7th Grade English Language Arts (M/J
Language Arts 2)

DELIVERY

Asynchronous On-Demand, 250 min/week;
Live 4-day option addressed below

CPALMS COURSE CODE

1001040

MODULES

6 (Gulliver's Travels · The Call of the Wild · A
Christmas Carol · The Outsiders · Short Story
Unit · The Scarlet Pimpernel)

GRADE BAND

Middle School, Grade 7

MANUAL BUILT FROM

The finished 03 Development course build
and the course build spec, revised 2026-08-
14 after the Florida × Texas dual-state
compliance pass (see Section 11)

How to use this manual. Sections 1–13 follow the required Optima Teacher Manual structure. Read Section 1 first for the shape of a normal week, then use the table of contents to jump to whatever you need on a given day: rubrics before you grade a project, the standards map before a parent conference, the sensitive-content scripts before a module opens. Every fact in this manual is read out of the built course (lesson pages, quiz specs, rubrics, and the course build spec) rather than assumed. Anything the manual could not confirm directly from the build is marked **[VERIFY]** and should be checked before you rely on it.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. How this course works	lesson, week, assessments
▶ Adapting to a Live 4-Day-Per-Week Class	compression guide
2. Ungraded interactives & the intro/outro wrappers	
3. AI & VR in this course (student-facing)	
4. Using Ignite AI to support students	teacher-facing
5. Grading categories & gradebook setup	
6. Rubrics for every teacher-graded item	
7. Discussions, quizzes & interactives: how to run & grade	
8. Coach, not catch	
9. Weekly announcement scripts	
10. Teacher workflow & workload map	+ fluctuation graphic
11. Standards coverage map	incl. confirmed gaps
12. What makes this course classical	& cultivating culture
13. Sensitive-content flags & scripts	

1 HOW THIS COURSE WORKS

The course tells six stories across a school year: *Gulliver's Travels* (Q1), *The Call of the Wild* and *A Christmas Carol* (Q2), *The Outsiders* and a short-story unit (Q3), and *The Scarlet Pimpernel* (Q4). Every module runs the same weekly rhythm and lands in the same single Tier-3 project, graded on the same four-criterion rubric, so the shape of the course never changes even though the book does.

Course at a glance

MODULE	TEXT (STATUS)	WEEKS	QUARTER	WRITING FOCUS	FINAL PROJECT
1 Gulliver's Travels	Swift, 1726 (public domain)	8 (Wk8 = project)	Q1	Open argument	Written argument + Lilliput/Brobdingnag creative contrast + VR + reflection
2 The Call of the Wild	London, 1903 (public domain)	6 (Wk6 = reading + project)	Q2	Argumentative (thesis → evidence → counterclaim → conclusion)	Argumentative essay + creative (student choice) + VR
3 A Christmas Carol	Dickens, 1843 (public domain)	2 (compact; Wk2 lean + project)	Q2	Theme analysis / creative	Book cover + written reflection + VR
4 The Outsiders	Hinton, 1967 (in copyright: special rules)	7 (Wk7 = project)	Q3	Literary analysis	Essay + creative choice (collage or research piece) + VR
5 Short Story Unit	Connell, 1924 (PD) + Dahl, "The Landlady" (in copyright, CommonLit link-out)	1 (intensive)	Q3	Narrative (write your own)	Suspense short story + author's note + VR
6 The Scarlet Pimpernel	Orczy, 1905 (public domain)	9 (Wk8 = outline workshop, Wk9 = project)	Q4	Argumentative	Essay + creative choice + VR

A typical lesson, walked top to bottom

Example: *Lesson 1.01: A Voyage to Lilliput: Meet Jonathan Swift and the Art of Satire* (Module 1, Week 1, Day 1). Every interactive lesson in the course follows this same shape:

- 1 Metadata strip.** Quarter/module, lesson number, topic, and the module question sit across the top so a student always knows where they are.
- 2 Title strip with a time pill.** A gold "≈14 min" badge gives an honest estimate. Every lesson, assignment, and quiz in the build carries one.
- 3 Today's Focus.** A one-line hook question, then two or three sentences naming what the lesson covers.
- 4 Objectives ("By the end of this lesson you will be able to...").** Two or three numbered, student-voice "I will be able to" statements.
- 5 What You Need.** The reading and the Reading Journal. **How the reading reaches the student differs by module, and this is the one setup step that will stop a class cold if you skip it.** See "Where the reading actually lives" immediately below.
- 6 The One Idea to Hold Onto.** A prominent inline HTML/CSS visual (three linked cards: exaggerate → hold up a mirror → make a point, for satire). This is the required core-concept visual; it is never an image.
- 7 Part 1: an ungraded check-in widget.** No wrong answer; every response gets a short, real piece of feedback. This is formation, not assessment (see Section 2).
- 8 Part 2: teaching prose,** with a "Did You Know?" background callout.
- 9 Part 3: the reading,** ending in a Reading Journal prompt ("Add this to the Week 1 section of your Reading Journal") and an evaluative widget with per-row instant feedback.
- 10 An AI-awareness callout** where it naturally fits (here: looking up an author's background). Factual, not persuasive; never a required tool. See Section 3.
- 11 What You'll Do Next:** routes the student to the Reading Journal entry, not a separate assignment.
- 12 Before You Go:** a short one-paragraph close tied back to the module question. No dramatic closer.

Where the reading actually lives (four different answers, by module)

There is no single mechanism. Check your module against this table before the first day of class, because two of the four rows need something from you.

MODULE	HOW THE STUDENT GETS THE TEXT	WHAT YOU MUST DO FIRST
1 Gulliver's Travels	The full text is embedded in the lesson pages , as 30 collapsible chapter panels labelled with a word count. The student clicks a panel open and reads in place.	Nothing. No upload, no link, no outside copy.
2 Call of the Wild 3 A Christmas Carol 5 Short Story Unit 6 Scarlet Pimpernel	The lesson points to a chapter or stave file you host in Canvas Files. All four texts are public domain, so you may reproduce them in full.	Upload the files and replace the placeholders. There are 36 of these across the four modules, and as of this writing none of the files exist in the Canvas course . See the warning below.
4 The Outsiders	The student reads their own copy. The novel is in copyright and is never reproduced by the course.	Confirm each student has a copy (purchase, library, or school set). The 16 placeholders in this module are <i>meant</i> to stay as own-copy notices.
4B Midsummer Night's Dream	Taught from short passages quoted inline in the lessons themselves. No full scene file is distributed.	Nothing. Optional: point students to a free full text if you want them reading beyond the quoted passages.

Read this before you open Module 2. Thirty-six lesson pages across Modules 2, 3, 5 and 6 carry a [Teacher: link the Chapter N PDF in Canvas Files here] placeholder, and the Canvas course currently contains only two files: this manual and the syllabus. **Every one of those 36 links points at a file that has not been uploaded.** A student reaching one of those lessons has no text to read. Module 1 is the exception and needs nothing, which can make the problem look solved for the first eight weeks and then surface all at once in Q2. All four texts are public domain, so hosting them is a permissions-free task, only an unfinished one.

Where's the graded touchpoint? Most literature and grammar lessons have none directly on the page. The comprehension work a lesson generates is captured downstream: in the Friday Check-up (auto-graded, weekly) and in the Reading Journal, which your Reading Journal Check reviews at the module's checkpoint(s), not weekly. Do not expect a submission from this page itself.

A typical week

Every module week (except the compact/short weeks noted per-module below) runs this five-day, ~250-minute rhythm. Reference: Module 1, Week 1 ("A Voyage to Lilliput: First Impressions").

DAY	WHAT THE STUDENT DOES	GRADED?	TIER
1	Literature Lesson 1 (reads assigned chapters; Reading Journal entry embedded in the lesson)	No direct submission: feeds the Journal	n/a
2	Grammar Lesson 1 + Word Study (vocabulary from the week's reading, copia-style rewrite)	Word Study: completion	Tier 1
3	Literature Lesson 2 + VR Activity 1 (feeds the module project)	VR 1: completion	Tier 1
4	Grammar Lesson 2 + combined Grammar POP! Quiz (covers both of the week's grammar topics) + VR Activity 2	POP quiz: auto-scored. VR 2: completion	Tier 1
5	Literature Lesson 3 + Friday Workshop: Quick Write (M365 Word doc) + Friday Check-up (cumulative quiz)	Quick Write: completion against success criteria. Friday Check-up: auto-scored	Tier 1

Every week opens with a Module Map page (this week's question, the five-day plan, and a running "ongoing all module" Reading Journal reminder) and every Friday Check-up ends with a submission checklist the student confirms before moving on.

Reading is a line item, not an add-on. Chapters run roughly 30–45 minutes for a typical two-chapter week at this grade; the build spec keeps total reading + activities inside a 230–270 minute band per week. Heavy-reading weeks (for example Module 1 Week 6, ~120 minutes of reading) deliberately drop to two literature lessons and one VR activity instead of three and two, so the week still lands near 250 minutes. Short weeks (Module 1 Week 3, around a school holiday) run four working days and one VR activity instead of two.

One week breaks the pattern entirely: Module 6, Week 2. It runs **four literature lessons and zero VR activities**, which is the only such week in the course. Both VR activities were removed to fund a poetic-form lesson (sonnet and villanelle) and a Poetry Workshop in which the student writes a poem. That week sits at **270 minutes, the top of the 230–270 band, with no slack left**. Do not add anything to it, and if you are compressing to a 4-day live schedule, this is the week to plan around rather than trim further. The trade was deliberate: it is what closes the poetic-form standard for Florida.

Major assessments

ASSESSMENT	FREQUENCY	TIER	WHAT IT ASKS	TEACHER TIME
Grammar POP! Quiz	Weekly (both grammar topics combined into one quiz)	1	8 multiple-choice items, Shurley-aligned terms, auto-scored, 2 attempts	~0 hrs (auto)
Friday Check-up	Weekly	1	8 cumulative multiple-choice items on the week's reading, craft, and grammar, auto-scored	~0 hrs (auto)
VR Activity 1 & 2	Weekly (2/week; 1/week in short weeks)	1	A solo staged VR scene + screenshot/video + short written reflection, completion-scored	~0 hrs (completion check)
Word Study	Weekly	1	5 words from the week's reading, rewritten lines (copia) + one original sentence	~0 hrs (completion, or a simple full/partial/minimal batch check)
Quick Write	Weekly	1	A short M365 Word document that scaffolds the module's Final Project	~0 hrs (completion against success criteria, not individualized feedback)
Research Task (Module 2, Week 4 only)	Once, in Module 2	1	"The Real Klondike": reads a non-fiction account beside the novel, then practises evaluating a source, distinguishing primary from secondary, and paraphrasing without plagiarising. Includes JSTOR access instructions	~0 hrs (completion)
Poetry Workshop (Module 6, Week 2 only)	Once, in Module 6	1	The student writes an original sonnet or villanelle into a supplied empty frame (rhyme scheme and refrain positions marked, no lines to copy). 10 pts, completion	~0 hrs (completion). Score the form, not the poetry
Module Discussion	Once per module	2	One claim-and-evidence post + one substantive reply, batch-scored on a 3-tier rubric	~4 hrs / 500 students, one time per module
Reading Journal Check	1–2 per module (mid + end in longer modules; end only in compact/one-week modules)	2	Light skim of Journal Sections 2, 3, 5 against a 3-tier completion rubric	~30–45 sec/journal, per occurrence
Module Outro Wrapper	Once per module	2 (survey, completion credit)	Refined module-question answer, confidence rating, "what's still unclear," virtue reflection	~15–20 min cohort triage
Final Project (Written + Creative/VR)	Once per module, the module's only deep-graded assessment	3	An argument or analysis essay + a creative/VR component, graded together on one 4-criterion rubric. Evidence must be cited in MLA form and the essay must end with a Works Cited entry (see the citation table in Section 6)	~8–12 hrs spread over the 1–2 week project window

► ADAPTING TO A LIVE 4-DAY-PER-WEEK CLASS

The course above is built for asynchronous, self-paced delivery: five days a week, about 50 minutes a day, 250 minutes total. Some facilitators teach this course live, meeting students four days a week instead of five. Nothing in the course needs to be cut to fit a 4-day live schedule; it needs to be re-sequenced. The two grammar lessons are the lightest content in the week (about 12 minutes each plus a 7-minute quiz), so they combine cleanly into one day, which frees a day for everything else to shift over by one.

The general 4-day template

LIVE DAY	IN CLASS	INDEPENDENT / HOMEWORK
Day 1	Literature Lesson 1, read together or discussed together; start the Reading Journal entry as a class before students finish it individually.	Finish the Journal entry if not done in class.
Day 2: "Grammar Day"	Grammar Lesson 1 <i>and</i> Grammar Lesson 2 back to back, ending in the combined Grammar POP! Quiz (it already covers both topics, so nothing extra is needed here).	Word Study (the vocabulary rewrite task): assign as independent work due before Day 3. It was already a self-paced written task, so moving it off live time costs nothing.
Day 3	Open with VR Activity 1 as a short warm-up (10–15 min) on the day the class meets in VR, then move into Literature Lesson 2.	—
Day 4	Literature Lesson 3, then VR Activity 2 , then start the Quick Write together, then the Friday Check-up as an exit ticket.	Finish the Quick Write (an M365 doc already meant to be worked on independently) if class time runs short.

Nothing is dropped: all three literature lessons, both grammar lessons, both VR activities, the Word Study, the Quick Write, the combined POP quiz, and the Friday Check-up all still happen every week. Word Study and the tail end of the Quick Write are the two pieces that move to independent time, since both were already designed as self-paced written tasks rather than live-facilitated ones.

Per-module notes (only where a module's rhythm genuinely differs)

Module 1, Week 3 (short week)

Already a 4-day week in the async build (one VR activity, not two, around the Labor Day break). It maps onto the 4-day live template with no further change: Day 1 Lit 1, Day 2 Grammar Day, Day 3 Lit 2 + the single VR activity, Day 4 Lit 3 + Quick Write + Friday Check-up.

Heavy-reading weeks (M1 Wks 2/4/6, similar lean weeks elsewhere)

These weeks already drop to two literature lessons and one VR activity. Use the freed live time for a longer guided-reading discussion on Day 1 or Day 3 rather than adding new content: the point of a lean week is protecting reading time, live or not.

Module 3, A Christmas Carol: Week 2 (lean + project launch)

Week 2 has only two literature lessons and one VR activity, and it also launches the Final Project. Suggested 4-day mapping: Day 1 Lit 1, Day 2 Grammar Day, Day 3 Lit 2 + the VR activity, Day 4 launch the book-cover Final Project and run the Friday Check-up. There is no Day-4 literature lesson to fold in this week, which is exactly what makes room for the project launch.

Module 5, Short Story Unit (1-week intensive)

This single week already follows the standard rhythm (3 lit lessons, 2 grammar, 2 VR, Quick Write, Friday Check-up): the 4-day template applies directly. Because there is no separate project week afterward, give students extra independent time after Day 4 to draft the suspense story itself; treat the in-class Quick Write as the story's opening scene rather than a finished piece.

Module 6, Week 2 (four lessons, no VR: the hardest week to compress)

This is the one week where the 4-day template does not simply absorb the async build, because there is no VR activity left to fold or drop. The week runs four literature lessons (2.01 disguise and characterization, 2.02 the two faces of Sir Percy, 2.03 sonnet and villanelle, 2.04 the Friday claim workshop), the Poetry Workshop, two grammar lessons, Word Study, and the Chapters 3 to 6 reading. Suggested mapping: Day 1 Lesson 2.01, Day 2 Grammar Day, Day 3 Lessons 2.02 and 2.03 together, Day 4 Lesson 2.04 plus the Friday Check-up, with the Poetry Workshop assigned as the week's independent work. **Do not drop 2.03 to make it fit:** it is the only lesson in the course that teaches poetic form, and cutting it reopens a Florida benchmark.

Module 6, Week 8 (outline workshop, no reading)

This week has no literature or grammar lessons at all: just four short sub-lessons (8.01 Thesis, 8.02 Evidence, 8.03 Counterargument, 8.04 Conclusion) plus 8.05 Submit. This maps one-to-one onto four live days with no compression needed: one sub-lesson per day, submission due after Day 4.

Project weeks (M1 Wk8, M2 Wk6, M3 Wk2, M4 Wk7, M6 Wk9)

No new reading or grammar. Suggested 4-day mapping: Day 1 launch + written-component work time, Day 2 finish and workshop the written component, Day 3 the creative + VR component, Day 4 finalize, submit, and complete the reflection. Use Day 1 or Day 3 to open with a peer-share of VR captures from earlier weeks as inspiration.

2 UNGRADED INTERACTIVES & THE INTRO/OUTRO WRAPPERS

Ungraded interactive activities

Every lesson page carries one or more `.optima-widget` components: a quick check-in (no wrong answer, every choice gets a real response), a "try it" select activity (evaluative, with per-row instant feedback and a Reset button), or a flip card. These live only on the GitHub-deployed lesson pages. They produce **no Canvas submission** and need **no grading**.

Treat these as formation, not busywork to chase. A student who skips a check-in widget shows up indirectly, in weaker Friday Check-up performance, a thinner Reading Journal, or a shakier Quick Write. It never shows up as a missing grade. Do not create a tracking system for widget completion; it does not exist in the gradebook and should not exist in your workflow either.

Intro/outro wrappers are Canvas Quizzes in survey mode

The Module Intro (before Week 1) and Module Outro (after the reading, before or during the project) are built as Canvas Quiz survey-mode specs, not as pages a student reads. That is deliberate: it turns the module question, the confidence check, and the virtue reflection into **sortable cohort data** across every student in the module, instead of prose you would have to read one at a time.

ITEM	CAPTURES	WHAT YOU DO WITH IT
Module Intro (4 items)	First answer to the module question; an objectives acknowledgment; a group-work opt-in for the Final Project; one "curious about" prompt	Sort the opt-in responses to arrange partners before the project opens. First-answer responses are your baseline for growth.
Module Outro (4 items)	Refined module-question answer (compare to the Intro); a confidence rating on the module's core skill; "what still feels unclear"; a virtue-reflection multiple choice + short answer	The confidence rating is your early-warning signal. The unclear-concept free text tells you what to re-teach.

The highest-leverage 20 minutes in the whole course: at each module's outro, spend 15–20 minutes triaging responses before you post the next announcement or open the project.

- 1 Sort the confidence-rating column. Pull every "Somewhat confident" and "Not yet confident" response to the top.
- 2 Scan the "what's still unclear" free-text column for repeats. Three or more students naming the same confusion is your signal to re-teach it, not an individual problem.
- 3 Act on what you find: a targeted announcement addressing the common confusion (Section 9), an Ignite AI-drafted check-in message to the low-confidence cluster (Section 4), or an individual message to a student who flagged something specific and personal.

3 AI & VR IN THIS COURSE (STUDENT-FACING)

AI: awareness, not required tool use

The built course never requires a student to use any specific AI tool, and never assigns AI use as a graded step. AI-awareness callouts appear inside literature lessons at natural moments: for example, Lesson 1.01 tells students an AI chatbot can summarize Jonathan Swift's biography or define satire in seconds, and that this is a fine starting point, but it "cannot notice for you which exact moments in Chapter 1 feel like satire and explain why. That noticing is your work as a reader." Callouts are factual about what AI can and cannot do for the specific task in front of the student; they never argue for or against AI use in general, and they never require an AI tool to complete an assignment.

Where these appear: background-and-definition lookups (author biographies, historical context, word meanings) are the recurring pattern across all six modules: always framed as a fast starting point, never as a substitute for the student's own reading and reasoning. You can speak to this directly with students: using AI to look something up is fine; using it to do the noticing, the claim, or the writing is not what the assignment is asking for.

VR: what the student actually does

Every VR activity is one solo, self-contained session inside a chosen virtual setting (the student defaults to picking their own setting; nothing is platform-specific and nothing names a particular VR product). The pattern is consistent across the whole course:

- 1 Enter a virtual space and pick any setting that fits the scene (a beach, a field, a room: the activity names the type, not a specific location).
- 2 Place a small number of objects, labels, or sticky notes to stage a moment from the reading (for example, a large object for Gulliver and several tiny ones for the Lilliputians, each labeled with a real detail from the chapter).
- 3 Capture the scene: take a screenshot inside VR, or record a short video.
- 4 Type a short written reflection (two to four sentences) connecting the staged scene to the week's reading or theme.

VR activities are completion-scored, not rubric-graded: the facilitator confirms a staged scene, accurate labels, and a submitted reflection are present, not a polished production. Every VR activity is explicitly designed to feed the module's Final Project (its creative + VR component), so a light facilitator note reviewing VR submissions midweek can double as an early look at how the project is shaping up. Consider assembling a gallery walk of a module's best VR captures once the project opens: the built course does not require this, but the captures are already there to use.

4 USING IGNITE AI TO SUPPORT STUDENTS

VERIFY BEFORE RELYING ON THIS SECTION. Ignite AI's exact feature names, buttons, and availability change with Canvas releases and with what Optima has turned on for this course. Confirm the current feature set in Optima's live Canvas instance before promising a specific capability to a new facilitator; the guidance below is written functionally so it should survive small interface changes, but no feature listed here is guaranteed to be enabled by default.

At 500 students to one facilitator, Ignite AI is the tool that makes individualized attention possible without individualized time. The rule governing every use below is the same: **AI drafts, the teacher decides.** You always read, edit, and own anything that reaches a student or a family. AI is never used to rank, surveil, or auto-penalize a student.

Drafting individualized feedback

Ask Ignite AI to draft a short comment for a Final Project submission, given the student's work and the rubric level you have already chosen. You edit it before posting. This is the one place in the course with real per-student written feedback (Tier 3), and it is exactly where a faster first draft matters most: the grading decision stays yours; the AI only saves you the blank-page time.

Summarizing discussion threads and wrapper analytics

Each module has one Module Discussion (roughly 500 posts and replies) and one Module Outro wrapper (500 confidence ratings and free-text responses). Ask Ignite AI to summarize the discussion's common claims and the outro's common "still unclear" answers before you triage them by hand. This turns a skim of 500 rows into a two-minute read of what actually needs your attention, which you then verify yourself against the sorted data (Section 2).

Surfacing students who need a nudge

Combine the outro's low-confidence cluster with a Friday Check-up score dip or a missed Word Study/Quick Write, and ask Ignite AI to draft a warm, specific check-in message naming what you noticed and inviting the student to reach out. You send it after reading it, in your own voice. This is early support, not a warning letter: see Section 8.

Generating practice variants

If a student misses the same Grammar POP! item type twice (for example, subject/verb identification), ask Ignite AI to generate two or three new practice sentences at the same difficulty, built on the same Shurley-aligned terms the course already uses (subject noun, action verb, and so on: never invent new terminology). Offer these as an extra rep, not a retest requirement.

Communicating with families

Ask Ignite AI to draft a clear, kind summary of a student's progress for a family update, or to translate a message for a family that prefers another language. This is especially useful around the sensitive-content advance notices in Section 13 and the required copyright notice families ask about for *The Outsiders* and *The Landlady*. You review every drafted message before it goes out.

5 GRADING CATEGORIES & CANVAS GRADEBOOK SETUP

The course's published grading weights (from the course syllabus, confirmed against the build's actual point distribution) map directly onto the tier system:

ASSIGNMENT GROUP (WEIGHT)	TIER	WHAT LANDS HERE
Daily Practice: 30%	1	Reading, Word Study, Grammar POP! quizzes, VR activities
Composition: 25%	1	Weekly Quick Writes (completion against success criteria, not individualized feedback)
Module Projects: 30%	3	The Final Project (written + creative + VR, one rubric)
Friday Check-ups, Discussions & Reading Journal Checks: 15%	1 & 2	Friday Check-ups (auto, Tier 1) plus the Module Discussion and Reading Journal Checks (Tier 2). This one group deliberately mixes tiers; do not try to split it further.

Step-by-step Canvas setup

- 1 In Canvas *Assignments* > *Assignment Groups*, create the four groups above with the exact weights shown (30 / 25 / 30 / 15), and confirm "Weight final grade based on assignment groups" is on.
- 2 Set the grading scheme to the school's standard letter-grade scheme (confirm the current scheme [\[VERIFY\]](#) against the school's grading policy; this is a school-wide setting, not module-specific).
- 3 Build the Module Intro and Module Outro as Canvas Quizzes with the **Survey** quiz type, not the Graded Quiz type: this removes them from point totals automatically while still tracking completion.
- 4 For Word Study, VR activities, and Quick Writes, use a small points value with **Complete/Incomplete** grading (or a simple 3-level rubric if you want a lighter full/partial/minimal distinction: see Section 6) rather than a full points rubric; per the grading model, these are not individually feedback-graded every week.
- 5 Set the course's late/missing policy to match the syllabus: a "sincere attempt: real effort on real work" standard, not a strict lateness penalty scheme. Confirm the exact late-work grace period [\[VERIFY\]](#) against current school policy.
- 6 Attach the standing 4-criterion rubric (Section 6) to both halves of the Final Project so they score together as one Canvas Rubric item in SpeedGrader.

Gradebook map

ITEM	ASSIGNMENT GROUP	TYPICAL POINTS	METHOD
Grammar POP! Quiz (weekly, combined)	Daily Practice	8	Auto
Word Study (weekly)	Daily Practice	10	Completion, or full/partial/minimal
VR Activity 1 & 2 (weekly)	Daily Practice	10 each	Completion
Quick Write (weekly)	Composition	15	Completion against success criteria
Poetry Workshop (Module 6 Wk 2 only)	Composition	10	Completion. Score whether the form was followed, not the quality of the poem
Research Task (Module 2 Wk 4 only)	Daily Practice	10	Completion
Friday Check-up (weekly)	Friday/Discussion/RJ Check group	8	Auto
Module Discussion (once/module)	Friday/Discussion/RJ Check group	~10	Rubric (3-tier, batch-scored)
Reading Journal Check (1–2/module)	Friday/Discussion/RJ Check group	~10 each	Rubric (3-tier completion, light skim)
Module Intro / Outro Wrapper	Not weighted (survey/completion)	0 or minimal completion	Survey
Final Project (Written + Creative/VR, together)	Module Projects	40 (4 criteria × 10)	Rubric

POINT VALUES ABOVE ARE DRAWN FROM THE BUILD'S ITEM-LEVEL SPECS, which describe most of them as "suggested" (for example, "suggested points: small value, for example 10 points" on the Module Discussion). Confirm the final point totals actually entered in Canvas before publishing grades, especially for Module 3 and Module 5, which run fewer weeks and so have fewer weekly Daily Practice and Composition items feeding their 30%/25% groups: you may need to adjust per-item points slightly so a two-week or one-week module's category totals stay proportional to an eight-week module's.

Using the module-progress view

Canvas's Module Requirements/progress view shows which ungraded scaffolding (widgets, Reading Journal reminders) a student has opened, at a glance, across the whole cohort. Use it as a quick completion signal between checkpoints; it is not a substitute for the Reading Journal Check, since opening a page is not the same as doing the work in it.

6 RUBRICS FOR EVERY TEACHER-GRADED ITEM

The standing Final Project rubric (reused across every module)

Four criteria, four levels, ten points each, forty points total. Criteria 2 through 4 are held byte-identical module to module; only Criterion 1's label and description shift to match what the module is actually asking students to understand. This is what keeps Tier-3 grading sustainable at roughly five minutes per student.

CRITERION	EXCELLENT (4)	PROFICIENT (3)	DEVELOPING (2)	BEGINNING (1)
1. Understanding of the text (label varies: see table below)	Clear, accurate grasp of the text and the module's theme; both halves of the project reflect what the book actually says	Understands the main events and the theme; a small detail may be off	Some understanding, with gaps or a misread of the theme or plot	Little accurate understanding of the text or the theme
2. Quality of reasoning and evidence	A clear claim/thesis backed by 2–3 well-chosen details with locations named, each explained, reasoning easy to follow	A claim with supporting evidence; explanations present but may be thin in a spot	A claim with little evidence, or evidence dropped in without explanation	No clear claim, or no real evidence
3. Clarity and precision	Well organized and easy to follow; sentences clear; the visual/VR scene communicates plainly; few errors	Mostly clear and organized; a few errors that do not block understanding	Hard to follow in places; errors or a muddled piece get in the way	Unclear or disorganized; the point is hard to see
4. Intellectual honesty	Uses evidence fairly, does not overstate, names where the argument is strong or uncertain; reflection is genuinely honest	Uses evidence fairly with no clear overreach; some honest self-awareness	Stretches evidence to fit, or claims more than the work shows	Evidence is misused or invented, or the reflection is not genuine

Criterion 2 now scores MLA citation. Here is the form each text takes.

Criterion 2's description carries one added requirement: *evidence must be cited in MLA format, giving the author's last name and the chapter or division, and the work must end with a Works Cited entry for the text*. The same sentence appears in every Final Project assignment, so a student who never opens the rubric still sees it.

Why there are no page numbers. The course delivers its texts as web pages and hosted files, which have no stable pagination, so a page locator is a number the student cannot honestly produce. MLA 9th edition covers exactly this case: an unpaginated work is cited by chapter or other division. **A citation reading (Swift 23) is wrong in this course and should be marked down under Criterion 2, not rewarded.** Act.scene.line form is likewise not used, including for the play.

MODULE AND TEXT	IN-TEXT FORM	NOTE
1 <i>Gulliver's Travels</i>	(Swift, Part II, Ch. 5)	Part and chapter, because Swift's chapter numbers restart in each Part
2 <i>The Call of the Wild</i>	(London, Ch. 3)	
3 <i>A Christmas Carol</i>	(Dickens, Stave 2)	Dickens's own division name, not "chapter"
4 <i>The Outsiders</i>	(Hinton, Ch. 7)	Students read their own copies, whose pagination differs by edition. Another reason chapter is the right locator
4B <i>A Midsummer Night's Dream</i>	(Shakespeare, 4.1)	Act and scene only. Do not require line numbers
5 <i>The Most Dangerous Game</i>	(Connelly)	A short story with no internal divisions, so author alone
6 <i>The Scarlet Pimpernel</i>	(Orczy, Ch. 10)	

A signal phrase is always an acceptable alternative to a parenthetical: *As Swift writes in Part II, Chapter 5, ...* Students are taught both and may use either.

How Criterion 1 is worded per module

MODULE	CRITERION 1 LABEL	WHAT IT IS REALLY CHECKING
1. Gulliver's Travels	Understanding of the text	Grasp of the voyages and the theme of pride
2. The Call of the Wild	Understanding of the text	Grasp of Buck's journey and the theme of transformation
3. A Christmas Carol	Understanding of the text	Grasp of Scrooge's story and the theme of change (adapted to the book-cover format)
4. The Outsiders	Understanding of the text	Grasp of the novel and the student's chosen theme (loyalty, family, or staying gold)
5. Short Story Unit	Use of the craft techniques (irony, suspense, and twist)	Whether the student's own story builds real suspense and lands a genuinely ironic, earned twist
6. The Scarlet Pimpernel	Understanding of the text	Grasp of the novel and the theme of heroism and disguise

Free-response quiz items: not applicable in this build

Every Grammar POP! Quiz and Friday Check-up read in this build (across Modules 1, 4, and 6, spanning both ordinary reading weeks and the Module 6 outline-workshop week) is 100% auto-scored multiple-choice or true/false, with per-answer feedback already written into the quiz spec. There are no teacher-scored free-response items in any quiz in this course. This section of the skill template (an answer guide for every free-response quiz question) is therefore not needed here: noted explicitly rather than silently omitted, per the requirement that a missing feature be stated, not dropped.

Other rubrics already in the build

ITEM	RUBRIC
Module Discussion (once/module)	Full credit: a clear claim backed by a specific text detail, plus a substantive reply engaging a classmate's reasoning. Partial credit: a claim or reply present but thin (no text detail, or a reply that only says "I agree"). Zero: missing or off-topic.
Reading Journal Check (1–2/module)	Full credit: all required weeks present in Sections 2 and 3, prompts answered in full sentences with text details, Section 5 shows a forming claim (end-of-module: claim + evidence). Partial credit: most weeks present but some prompts thin or missing text details. Minimal credit: large gaps, several weeks empty, little Section 5 work.

Paste every rubric above into its Canvas item as a native Canvas Rubric so it scores directly in SpeedGrader, rather than as text in the assignment description.

7 DISCUSSIONS, QUIZZES & INTERACTIVE/ASSESSMENT ACTIVITIES: HOW TO RUN & GRADE

General guidance by type

TYPE	SCORED HOW	RECOMMENDED TEACHER MOVE
Grammar POP! Quiz	Auto (Canvas New Quizzes, 2 attempts, shuffled answers)	Nothing to grade. Scan the item analysis after a few weeks to see if a Shurley term keeps tripping students; if so, mention it in the announcement (Section 9).
Friday Check-up	Auto, cumulative weekly check	Same as above. This is your best per-week pulse on whether the reading and grammar landed, without you reading anything.
Word Study	Completion, or a simple batch full/partial/minimal pass	Spot-check a handful each week rather than reading all 500; the real check on vocabulary depth happens at the Reading Journal Check (Section 2 of the Journal).
VR Activity	Completion (staged scene + accurate labels + submitted reflection)	Confirm the screenshot/video and reflection are present and on-topic; do not evaluate production quality. Consider a mid-module gallery glance to catch anyone stuck early.
Quick Write	Completion against stated success criteria	Check against the success-criteria checklist on the assignment page (word count, required elements); this is project practice, not a feedback-graded essay.
Module Discussion	3-tier rubric, batch-read	Read in one sitting per module; drop 2–3 public comments that model a strong claim, correct a common misread, or highlight a strong reply. Budget about 4 hours across 500 students, once per module.
Reading Journal Check	3-tier completion rubric, light skim (Sections 2, 3, 5 only)	Skim, do not read every line. One brief note per student at most (for example, "catch up Week 3 before the project").
Module Intro / Outro Wrapper	Survey (completion credit)	See Section 2's triage move. Not individually reviewed per student.
Final Project (Written + Creative/VR)	4-criterion Canvas Rubric	One rubric click per criterion + one short overall comment. Budget about 5 minutes per student across the project window (Section 6).

Per-instance notes

MODULE	DISCUSSION PROMPT (TIER 2)	READING JOURNAL CHECK TIMING	FINAL PROJECT
1. Gulliver's Travels	Weeks 5–6: a claim-and-reason post on what Swift says about human pride, backed by a Brobdingnag or Houyhnhnm detail	Mid-module (~Wk 4) + end (Wk 7)	Due Week 8: written argument + Lilliput/Brobdingnag creative contrast + VR scale scene + reflection
2. The Call of the Wild	Weeks 4–5: a claim-and-reason post on transformation and the pull between civilization and the wild	Mid-module + end (6-week module) [VERIFY exact weeks]	Due Week 6: argumentative essay + creative choice + VR transformation scene
3. A Christmas Carol	Weeks 1–2: can a person truly change? / generosity vs. greed	End only (2-week compact module)	Due Week 2: book cover + written reflection + VR transformation scene
4. The Outsiders	Theme: loyalty / the greaser-Soc divide (required-notice reminder applies to every module-level page)	Mid-module (~Wks 3–4) + end (Wk 6/7)	Due Week 7: literary-analysis essay + creative choice (collage or research piece) + VR thematic scene
5. Short Story Unit	What makes suspense work, within Week 1	End only (1-week intensive)	Due end of Week 1: original suspense story + author's note + VR story scene
6. The Scarlet Pimpernel	Week 1: "When is it right to risk everything for strangers?"	Mid-module (~Wk 4) + end (Wk 7)	Due Week 9 (after the Week 8 outline workshop): argumentative essay + creative choice + VR thematic scene

This table cross-references Sections 6 and 11; the rubric and standards details for each item live there rather than being repeated here.

8 COACH, NOT CATCH

Your job is to move each student forward, not to detect and punish. At 500 students, the tools in this manual (analytics, Ignite AI, the outro triage) exist to find who needs help early, not to build a case against anyone.

- **Feedback names the next step, not just the error.** Lead with what is working before naming what to fix, in every Final Project comment.
- **Allow re-attempts on Tier 1 practice.** Grammar POP! quizzes already allow two attempts by design; treat that as a learning tool, not a ceiling to police.
- **Use analytics to find students who need help early, then reach out.** A low confidence rating on the outro or a quiet week of missed Word Study is a signal to check in, not a strike.
- **On suspected academic dishonesty or AI misuse, open a conversation first.** Ask the student to talk through their thinking on the Final Project or Quick Write. Treat it as formation: a chance to re-teach what honest use of evidence and honest use of AI look like, not an accusation-first process.
- **Public discussion comments model good thinking; they never single out weak work.** When you drop the 2–3 public comments after a Module Discussion, choose strong or improvable-but-good-faith posts, never a "do not do this" example tied to a real student.

9 WEEKLY ANNOUNCEMENT SCRIPTS

Because students work asynchronously, your weekly announcement is your main visible presence in the course. Use the reusable template for any week, then adapt the module-specific and situational scripts below.

Reusable template: any [Module/Week N]

TEMPLATE

Hi everyone: welcome to [Module X, Week N]. This week you are reading [chapters/pages] and working on [the week's focus, e.g. "the Lilliputian government as satire"]. The one thing not to miss this week: [the due item, e.g. "Quick Write 4 is due Friday"], and [a tricky concept, e.g. "watch for how the counterclaim lesson works: it will help on the POP quiz"]. [One warm, specific line of encouragement tied to the week's content.]

One drafted script per module

MODULE 1: GULLIVER'S TRAVELS, OPENING WEEK

Welcome to Module 1! This module we travel with Gulliver to Lilliput, Brobdingnag, and the land of the Houyhnhnms, and we keep asking one question all module long: how does changing your perspective change what you see, in others and in yourself? This week, get your Reading Journal set up and read Chapters 1–2: Gulliver has just washed up on a beach full of six-inch people, and it is worth noticing how they treat someone that much bigger than themselves. Have fun with the size jokes; there is something serious underneath them.

MODULE 2: THE CALL OF THE WILD, ARGUMENT-BUILDING WEEK

This week Buck faces "the law of club and fang," and we start building toward your argumentative essay: Quick Write 2 asks you for a thesis and one reason. Take your time with the thesis; everything else this module builds on it. If pinning down a claim about Buck's change feels hard this week, that is normal this early: it will sharpen as the reading continues.

MODULE 3: A CHRISTMAS CAROL, PROJECT WEEK

We are in the final week of a short, intense module. Staves 3 through 5 move fast: three spirits, one turning point, and Scrooge's whole future in question. The Final Project (a book cover that captures the novella's central theme) opens this week: start thinking about your image before you sit down to build it. What single image would tell someone who never read the book what it is really about?

MODULE 4: THE OUTSIDERS, OPENING WEEK

Welcome to The Outsiders. A reminder before we start: you will need your own lawful copy of the novel for this module; our lessons teach around the book rather than reproducing it, so keep your copy handy for every reading. This week we meet Ponyboy and the divide between the greasers and the Socs. Watch for the novel's first-person voice: whose story is this, and why might that matter by the end?

MODULE 5: SHORT STORY UNIT, THE ONE-WEEK INTENSIVE

This module moves fast: one week, two short stories, and your own suspense story due at the end. "The Most Dangerous Game" opens with a hunter becoming the hunted: watch for situational and dramatic irony as you read, since you will use both in your own story. Do not wait until Friday to start drafting; the Quick Write this week is meant to become your story's opening scene.

MODULE 6: THE SCARLET PIMPERNEL, OPENING WEEK

Our final module of the year opens in Paris in 1792, with the guillotine running and an unknown Englishman risking his life for strangers. This week's discussion question carries the whole module: when is it right to risk everything for someone you have never met? Start reading with that question in mind: you will come back to it at the essay outline workshop in Week 8.

Situational scripts

MID-MODULE CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

I looked back at last week's confidence check, and a few of you flagged [the specific concept] as still unclear. You are not alone if that is you. [One or two sentences re-explaining the concept plainly, or pointing back to the specific lesson that covers it.] If it is still fuzzy after this, reply here or message me: that is exactly what office hours are for.

PRE-MAJOR-ASSESSMENT PUSH

The Final Project opens [date]. You have already done real work toward it: your Quick Writes from [weeks] are the raw material for the written half, and your VR captures from every week are the raw material for the creative half. This week, reread your own Quick Writes before you start writing the final piece: you will be surprised how much is already there.

RE-ENGAGEMENT NUDGE FOR A QUIET STUDENT

Hi [student name]: I noticed I have not seen work from you since [date/item]. No judgment here; life gets busy. I would love to help you get back on track. Can you reply and let me know where things stand, or is there a specific assignment I can walk you through? You have ten consecutive school days before an absence needs a note home, and I would much rather hear from you before than after.

10 TEACHER WORKFLOW & WORKLOAD MAP

A normal week, in order

- 1 Skim any open Module Outro triage items if a module wraps this week (15–20 min; Section 2).
- 2 Batch-read the Module Discussion if this is its week (about 4 hrs across 500 students, once per module; Section 7).
- 3 Grade the Final Project if one is due this week (about 5 min/student across the window; Section 6).
- 4 Post the weekly announcement (Section 9).
- 5 Answer student and family messages as they arrive.

Tier 1 items (POP quizzes, Friday Check-ups, VR completion, Word Study, Quick Writes) require essentially no per-item teacher time in an ordinary week: that is the design. The teacher-time budget concentrates almost entirely in the weeks a Discussion, a Reading Journal Check, or the Final Project lands.

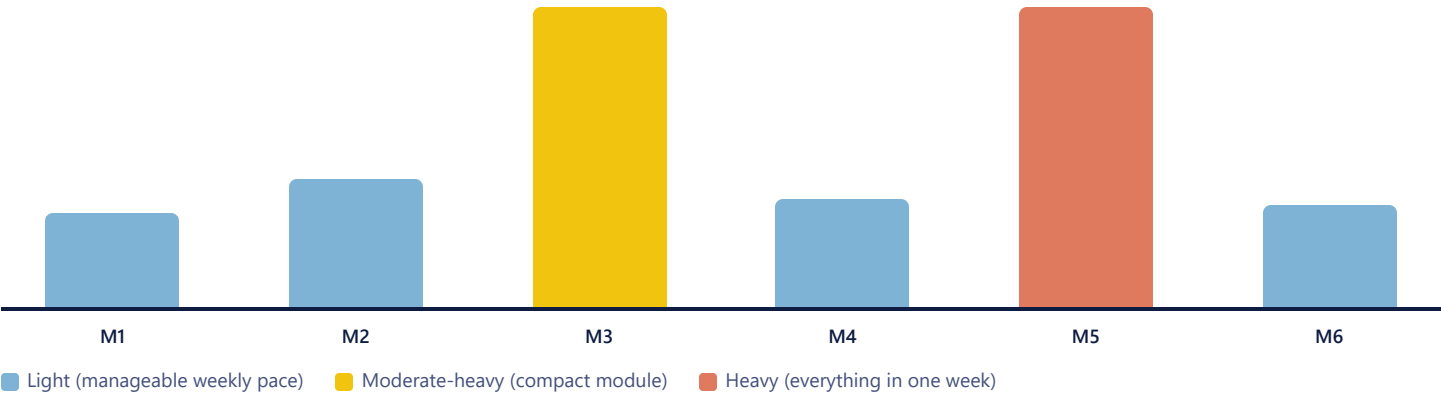
Heavy weeks to flag

Every module carries exactly one Discussion, one or two Reading Journal Checks, and one Final Project: but modules differ sharply in how many weeks those land across, which changes how concentrated the load feels. Module 3 (2 weeks) and Module 5 (1 week) pack a Discussion, a Reading Journal Check, and the Final Project into a very small window; Module 6's Week 8 outline workshop adds a fourth touchpoint (a light completion check on each student's submitted outline) right before its own Week 9 project.

Module 6 Week 2 is heavy for a different reason. It is not a grading load, it is a student load: four literature lessons in one week, the heaviest reading stretch of the module (Chapters 3 through 6), plus a Poetry Workshop, and no VR activity to break the pattern. It sits at 270 minutes, the ceiling. Students who have coasted on the VR activities as a change of pace will feel this week. If you send one "check in on your pacing" message all year, send it on the Monday of Module 6 Week 2.

The workload-fluctuation graphic

Bar height = modeled teacher hours **per week of the module** (total estimated hours ÷ weeks), using the tier time-budget logic above (Discussion ≈4 hrs once/module; each Reading Journal Check ≈30–45 sec × 500 students ≈4–6 hrs; Outline Review in M6 Wk8 ≈similar; Final Project ≈8–12 hrs spread over its window) applied to each module's real item counts. This is a planning estimate, not a guarantee: **[VERIFY]** against your actual section size and pacing.



Read this chart by density, not by total hours. Every module carries roughly the same total teacher-hour load overall (each has one Discussion, one Final Project, and one or two Reading Journal Checks). What changes is how many weeks that load is spread across. Module 3 and Module 5 are genuinely the intensive modules the build spec calls out: not because they ask more of you in total, but because a full module's worth of Tier-2 and Tier-3 work compresses into one or two weeks instead of six to nine. Plan your own calendar accordingly: clear extra grading time around Module 3's two weeks and especially around Module 5's single week, rather than assuming the light week-to-week pace of Modules 1, 2, 4, and 6 will hold.

11 STANDARDS COVERAGE MAP

Codes below are the course's verified CPALMS ELA.7 standards, cross-checked against the actual built lessons. These codes are for teacher use only; they never appear on a student-facing page (rule: teach the skill, not the code or the method).

By standard

STANDARD	SHORT DESCRIPTION	MODULES THAT TEACH IT
ELA.7.R.1.1	Cite textual evidence to support analysis	All six modules
ELA.7.R.1.2	Analyze theme development	M2, M3, M4, M6
ELA.7.R.1.3	Analyze structural elements (setting, characterization, point of view)	All six modules (fixed 2026-08-13: the point-of-view terms the benchmark names are now taught explicitly in M1 Week 3)
ELA.7.R.1.4	Analyze how a poem's form/structure shapes meaning	M2 (Robert Service, "The Cremation of Sam McGee"), M4 (Frost, "Nothing Gold Can Stay"), M6 Week 2 (fixed 2026-08-13: sonnet and villanelle named, with Shakespeare's Sonnet 18 and Robinson's "The House on the Hill")
ELA.7.R.2.1	Analyze structure/organization of a text	M1, M5, M6
ELA.7.R.2.3	Analyze author's purpose/rhetoric	M1, M6
ELA.7.R.3.1	Analyze figurative language, including allusion	All six modules (fixed 2026-08-13: allusion, which the benchmark names, is now taught in M1 Week 4 and M3 Week 1)
ELA.7.R.3.2	(paired analysis standard tracked alongside R.3.1 in this build)	All six modules
ELA.7.R.3.4	Analyze rhetoric / how an author takes a stand	M6 only
ELA.7.C.1.2	Write narratives	M1, M3, M5
ELA.7.C.1.3	Write arguments with counterclaims	M2, M4
ELA.7.C.1.5	Improve writing through the writing process	All six modules
ELA.7.C.3.1	Present information (writing-process presentation standard tracked in this build)	All six modules
ELA.7.C.1.4	Write expository pieces from multiple sources	M4 (fixed 2026-07-16: research option now requires 2+ sources, cited)
ELA.7.C.2.1	Present information orally in a logical sequence	All six modules (fixed 2026-07-16: see note below)
ELA.7.C.5.1	Use digital tools/media in a creative product	M3 (book cover), M4 (collage option)
ELA.7.C.5.2	Use digital tools to produce and share writing	All six modules: every Quick Write, Reading Journal, and Final Project (see note below)
ELA.7.R.2.2	Compare two or more central ideas within a text	M1, M2, M4, M6 (fixed 2026-07-16: see note below)
ELA.7.R.2.4	Track an argument's reasoning, including fallacies	M2, M6 (fixed 2026-07-16: see note below)
ELA.7.R.3.3	Compare authors with differing perspectives on a shared topic	M5 (fixed 2026-07-16: see note below)
ELA.7.C.4.1	Conduct research and evaluate sources	M2 Week 4 and M4 (fixed 2026-08-13: M2 now has a required research task using a non-fiction Klondike source, with source evaluation, primary vs secondary, and paraphrase vs plagiarism)
ELA.K12.EE.1.1	Cite evidence using a recognized style guide	All six modules (fixed 2026-08-13: MLA in-text form plus a Works Cited entry, in every citation-teaching lesson, all Final Project essays and reflections, and all seven rubrics)
ELA.7.V.1.1	Vocabulary acquisition from context/reading	All six modules (the weekly Word Study)

STANDARD	SHORT DESCRIPTION	MODULES THAT TEACH IT
ELA.7.V.1.2	Greek/Latin roots and affixes	All six modules (fixed 2026-07-16: see note below)
ELA.7.V.1.3	Context clues, connotation and denotation	All six modules (fixed 2026-07-16: see note below)

ELA.7.C.5.2 is met everywhere but was never tagged in the build notes. Every Quick Write, Reading Journal entry, and Final Project across all six modules requires an M365 Word document built with named skill steps (Heading styles, tables), saved to OneDrive, and submitted through the Canvas + OneDrive LTI. That is a real, weekly demonstration of "using digital tools to produce and share writing," so it is tagged against every module in the table above even though the module-level build notes never named it.

By module (quick reference)

MODULE	STANDARDS CARRIED
1. Gulliver's Travels	R.1.1, R.1.3, R.2.1, R.2.2, R.2.3, R.3.1, R.3.2, C.1.2, C.1.5, C.2.1, C.3.1, V.1.1, V.1.2, V.1.3, C.5.2, EE.1.1
2. The Call of the Wild	R.1.1, R.1.2, R.1.3, R.1.4, R.2.2, R.2.4, R.3.1, R.3.2, C.1.3, C.1.5, C.2.1, C.3.1, C.4.1, V.1.1, V.1.2, V.1.3, C.5.2, EE.1.1
3. A Christmas Carol	R.1.1, R.1.2, R.1.3, R.3.1, R.3.2, C.1.2, C.1.5, C.2.1, C.3.1, C.5.1, V.1.1, V.1.2, V.1.3, C.5.2, EE.1.1
4. The Outsiders	R.1.1, R.1.2, R.1.3, R.1.4, R.2.2, R.3.1, R.3.2, C.1.3, C.1.5, C.2.1, C.3.1, C.4.1, C.5.1, V.1.1, V.1.2, V.1.3, C.5.2, EE.1.1
5. Short Story Unit	R.1.1, R.1.3, R.2.1, R.3.1, R.3.2, R.3.3, C.1.2, C.1.5, C.2.1, C.3.1, V.1.1, V.1.2, V.1.3, C.5.2, EE.1.1
6. The Scarlet Pimpernel	R.1.1, R.1.2, R.1.3, R.1.4, R.2.1, R.2.2, R.2.3, R.2.4, R.3.1, R.3.4, C.1.3, C.1.5, C.2.1, C.3.1, V.1.1, V.1.2, V.1.3, C.5.2, EE.1.1

Gaps closed 2026-07-16: what changed and where

A prior audit read the actual lesson files (not just the plan) and confirmed seven standards were genuinely absent from the built course, not merely untagged, plus one standard only partially met. All eight were fixed directly in the built course on 2026-07-16, each with the lightest-touch edit that could close it without disturbing existing content, widgets, or grading. What follows documents what changed; there is nothing left to remediate from this audit.

ELA.7.C.2.1 (present information orally in a logical sequence): **fixed in all six Final Project creative/VR assignments.** Each now requires a graded 30-60 second spoken explanation as part of the VR/creative capture (the student narrates the scene in sequence, naming the key point it makes about the module's theme), not offered as an either/or against a silent screenshot. Each module's standing rubric (Criterion 3, Clarity and precision) now scores the spoken explanation's sequence and clarity.

ELA.7.R.2.2 (compare two or more central ideas within a text): **fixed in one lesson each in Modules 1, 2, 4, and 6** ([W6 L1](#) Two Societies Side by Side; [W4 L2](#) The Skilled and the Unskilled; [W1 L1](#) Meet S. E. Hinton; [W5 L2](#) Courage Without a Script). Each now has a "One Step Further" callout with a two-panel comparison naming the distinct central idea the text builds through each side, and how the two develop and diverge.

ELA.7.R.2.4 (track an argument's reasoning, including fallacies): **fixed in Module 2 Week 4** ([W4 L3](#) - [Answering the Other Side.html](#)), which now teaches three informal fallacies (attacking the person, a false either/or, a hasty generalization) with generic practice examples and a spot-the-fallacy widget, and **reinforced in Module 6 Week 8** ([8.03](#) - [Counterargument.html](#)), which asks students to check their own outline's counterargument against the same three fallacies.

ELA.7.R.3.3 (compare authors with differing perspectives on a shared topic): **fixed in Module 5 Week 1** ([W1 L3](#) - [The Twist Ending and The Landlady.html](#)), which now has a "Two Authors, One Hidden Danger" section reframing the existing MDG/Landlady pairing around what each author seems to believe about danger hiding in ordinary places, routed to the Reading Journal alongside the existing craft comparison.

ELA.7.V.1.2 (Greek/Latin roots and affixes): **fixed in all 28 Word Study assignments across all six modules.** Each now has a "Word Roots" callout giving the verified Latin or Greek root for 2-3 of that week's real vocabulary words (roots without a clean classical derivation were deliberately skipped rather than guessed).

ELA.7.V.1.3 (context clues, connotation and denotation): **fixed in the same 28 Word Study assignments.** Each now has a "Before You're Told: Context Clues" prompt asking the student, before reading the definition, what in the surrounding sentence hints at one word's meaning.

ELA.7.C.1.4 (write expository pieces from multiple sources): **fixed in Module 4's Final Project:** the optional "Social Issue Research Piece" path now requires at least two reliable sources, cited, instead of one. It remains an either/or choice against the character-collage option, so the standard is guaranteed only for the students who choose the research path.

Gaps closed 2026-08-13: the Florida × Texas dual-state pass

A second audit crosswalked the built course against **both** the Florida B.E.S.T. benchmarks and the Texas TEKS §110.23, because the course is taught in both states. The finding worth knowing up front: **the two standards sets overlap so heavily that there is almost nothing to mute for either state.** Roughly 80% of the course serves both without modification, and the gaps the audit found were shared gaps, not state-specific ones. Everything below was fixed directly in the built course.

ELA.K12.EE.1.1 (6–8) and TEKS 12(I) (cite using a recognized style guide): **fixed course-wide.** MLA in-text citation and a Works Cited entry are now taught in all five citation lessons, required in all twelve Final Project essays and reflections, and scored under Criterion 2 of all seven rubrics. The locator is a chapter or division rather than a page number, because the course's texts are unpaginated. See the citation table in Section 6.

ELA.7.R.1.4 and TEKS 8(B) (poetic form): **fixed in Module 6, Week 2.** The course previously taught only ballad and couplet, which failed R.1.4's own clarification. A new lesson names and analyzes the **sonnet** (Shakespeare's Sonnet 18) and the **villanelle** (Edwin Arlington Robinson's "The House on the Hill"), both verified public domain from Project Gutenberg. This landed in Module 6 rather than the Shakespeare module on purpose: see the note on Module 4/4B below.

TEKS 11(A) (compose literary text, including poetry): **fixed in the same week.** The new Poetry Workshop has the student write an original sonnet or villanelle into an empty frame that marks where each rhyme and refrain falls. Score the form, not the artistry.

ELA.7.R.3.1 (figurative language, which names allusion): **fixed in Module 1 Week 4 and Module 3 Week 1.** Allusion is now named and taught, using Swift's "whether I was a whig or tory" and the biblical and seasonal allusions in Dickens.

ELA.7.R.1.3 and TEKS 9(E) (point of view): **fixed in Module 1 Week 3.** The teaching was already there; the vocabulary was not. The lesson now names **unreliable narrator**, **third person limited**, **third person omniscient**, and **subjective versus objective account**. These are content terms students are assessed on, not pedagogical method names, so naming them does not breach the build rule against naming techniques.

ELA.7.C.4.1 and TEKS 12(D)–(I) (research and inquiry): **partly fixed, in Module 2 Week 4.** A required research task, "The Real Klondike," now pairs a non-fiction account with the novel and teaches source evaluation, primary versus secondary sources, and paraphrase versus plagiarism. Two supporting reference pages were added to Module 0: "How Arguments Work" and "Research Starting Points," plus a Canvas-only page carrying the shared JSTOR access details. **This strand is improved, not closed:** one task in one module is still thin against a TEKS strand that runs 12(A) through 12(J).

TEKS 11(D) (correspondence): **fixed in Module 6 Week 6.** Quick Write 6, "A Letter from Inside the Story," has the student write in role as a character, choosing a business letter that registers a complaint or requests information, or a personal letter of opinion. The novel's plot turns on a seized letter, so the task sits naturally in the text rather than being bolted on.

TEKS 10(D)(iii) (conjunctive adverbs): **fixed in Module 2 Week 4,** inside the existing Semicolons and Colons grammar lesson and its POP! quiz, rather than as a new lesson.

Two build defects, not standards gaps, also fixed. Module 2 Week 5 and Module 4 Week 3 each taught a poem that was not actually on the page: "The Cremation of Sam McGee" and "Nothing Gold Can Stay" were both [Teacher: paste...] placeholders. Both poems are public domain and both are now reproduced in full.

What this cost, and where. The weekly time budget is locked, so new content had to displace something rather than be added. **Module 6 Week 2 lost both of its VR activities** to fund the poetry lesson and the Poetry Workshop. That was a deliberate ruling: cut a VR activity before cutting a literature lesson. It is also the reason that week now runs four lessons with no VR and sits at the top of the time band.

Why the poetry work is in Module 6 and not Module 4B. Modules 4 and 4B are alternates: a teacher runs *The Outsiders* or *A Midsummer Night's Dream*, never both. Anything placed in only one of them is missed entirely by every student on the other track. Standards coverage therefore cannot rest in either module alone, which is why sonnet and villanelle went to Module 6 even though the Shakespeare module was the obvious home.

STILL OPEN AFTER THIS PASS The audit named four gaps that remain: **INFORMATIONAL TEXT AND PUBLISHED ARGUMENT AS THINGS STUDENTS READ** (the largest one, and the cheapest fix is pairing each novel with a short public-domain non-fiction piece on the same subject); **DRAMA**, which is TEKS-only and is fully served for any section running Module 4B; **EXPOSITORY WRITING FROM MULTIPLE SOURCES**, currently guaranteed only for students who choose the research path in Module 4's project; and **ORAL LANGUAGE**, which rests on one recorded item per module. None blocks either state's core requirements, and all four are recorded in the standards crosswalk in the course's shared folder.

12 WHAT MAKES THIS COURSE CLASSICAL & CULTIVATING CULTURE

What makes it classical

- **A real encounter with primary texts, across centuries.** Six public-domain-or-carefully-taught works spanning 1726 to 1967 (Swift, London, Dickens, Connell, Orczy, Hinton) put students in direct contact with the actual books, not summaries of them: even where copyright requires teaching around a text (*The Outsiders*, "The Landlady"), the course still points students to the real book rather than substituting a paraphrase for it.
- **The grammar sequence teaches through a worked example before naming the rule:** every grammar lesson models the Shurley-aligned Question-and-Answer Flow on a real sentence pulled from that week's reading before students practice on a new line, then apply it in their own writing. The method is never named to students; the manual can name it here because this is the teacher's document.
- **One organizing question per module, revisited rather than answered once.** The Reading Journal's Section 1 asks students to add a new dated line to the same module question every week, and the Intro/Outro wrappers explicitly compare a student's first answer to their refined one: the point is watching one's own thinking change, not landing on a final answer early.
- **The virtue thread is concrete, not decorative.** Every Module Outro asks students to name the one virtue the text most needed and connect it to a real moment in the story or their own work: Module 1 offers honesty, self-government, and perseverance against Gulliver's pride; Module 4 offers service, courage, and honesty against the greaser-Soc divide. The virtue is tied to the specific text each time, not a generic list.
- **Intellectual honesty is a graded criterion, not a slogan.** The standing Final Project rubric's fourth criterion explicitly rewards a student who names where their own argument is weaker or less certain: formation toward honest reasoning is built into the grade, every module, all year.

Cultivating culture asynchronously

- **Make the Module Discussion visibly a conversation, not a drop box.** The 2–3 public comments you leave after batch-reading each module's discussion are the clearest place students see the class thinking together; use them to name good reasoning by name, not just to correct.
- **Let the weekly announcement model curiosity, not just logistics.** The drafted scripts in Section 9 each end on a real question about the text: ask it and mean it, rather than treating the announcement as a due-date reminder only.
- **Keep the virtue thread visible outside the outro.** A one-line nod to the module's virtue in an announcement (for example, naming perseverance when a heavy-reading week lands) connects the formal reflection to the week students are actually living through.
- **Treat feedback as relationship, especially at the one deep-graded moment.** The Final Project comment is the one place in the course where a student gets your individual attention in writing: even at 500:1, a comment that names something specific and true about their thinking does more for classroom culture than a faster one that does not.

13 SENSITIVE-CONTENT FLAGS & FAMILY/STUDENT SCRIPTS

Flags below are drawn from the actual built lessons and the works themselves. Send the relevant script before the module (or the flagged week) opens, not after.

Module 2: The Call of the Wild: animal violence and cruelty

Where: Week 1 ("The Law of the Club," a man beats Buck into submission with a club) and Week 4 ("The Toil of Trace and Trail," the cruelty of the unskilled masters Hal, Charles, and Mercedes toward the sled dogs). The built lesson itself describes "the end of the beating" and frames it directly as the book's turning point; this is Jack London's Naturalist material, not softened.

SUGGESTED FAMILY/STUDENT SCRIPT

This module we read Jack London's *The Call of the Wild* (1903), which follows a dog's journey from a comfortable home into the harsh working life of the Yukon gold rush. The book includes scenes of animal violence, including a beating early in the story and later cruelty from an inexperienced dog team's owners: London uses these moments to explore themes of survival, instinct, and adaptation, and our lessons treat them as the serious literary turning points they are. If you have questions about the reading or want to talk with your student about a specific scene, please reach out to [\[facilitator name/contact\]](#).

Module 3: A Christmas Carol: ghosts, death, and a child's mortality

Where: Week 2. Scrooge is shown his own neglected grave by the Ghost of Christmas Yet to Come, and the same vision shows Tiny Tim's death before Scrooge's change prevents it: the built Friday Check-up quiz directly references "the neglected grave" and Tiny Tim's fate as comprehension content.

SUGGESTED FAMILY/STUDENT SCRIPT

This module we read Charles Dickens's *A Christmas Carol* (1843). The story includes ghostly visitations and a vision of a possible future in which a child does not survive: Dickens uses this directly to make his argument about generosity and social responsibility, and the story's ending reverses that vision. These are classic, widely taught scenes handled with the same care Dickens gives them; if your student finds the ghost imagery unsettling, or if you would like to preview the reading together, contact [\[facilitator name/contact\]](#).

Module 4: The Outsiders: gang conflict, a character's death, and copyright

Where: Weeks 5–6, the novel's climax ("the rumble and the hospital"). The built lesson deliberately does not name what happens ("It is not a fight or a victory. It is a loss, and it changes the direction of the story permanently") to stay inside the course's copyright policy for this in-copyright novel, but the underlying event is a character's death. Every page in this module also carries a required copyright notice: students must obtain lawful access to the novel separately, since Optima materials teach about the book rather than reproducing it.

SUGGESTED FAMILY/STUDENT SCRIPT

This module we read S. E. Hinton's *The Outsiders* (1967). Two notes before we begin: first, this novel is still under copyright, so your student will need their own lawful copy (school library, purchase, or another approved source): our lessons teach about the book rather than reproducing its text. Second, the story includes conflict between two rival groups and, at its climax, the death of a major character; Hinton wrote the novel as a teenager herself, and the story is a widely taught, serious look at class division, loyalty, and loss. Please reach out to [\[facilitator name/contact\]](#) with any questions or for help securing a copy of the book.

Module 5: Short Story Unit: a hunted human, and a sinister undertone

Where: Week 1 (the module's only week). "The Most Dangerous Game" (Connell) centers on a wealthy hunter who hunts human beings for sport; "The Landlady" (Dahl, taught about only, linked to CommonLit) builds a quietly sinister undertone around a boarding house's missing former guests. Neither story is graphic, but both are built on real menace as their central craft device.

SUGGESTED FAMILY/STUDENT SCRIPT

This module is a one-week intensive on suspense writing, using two classic short stories: "The Most Dangerous Game" (Richard Connell, 1924), in which a hunter becomes the hunted, and "The Landlady" (Roald Dahl), which we teach about and link to on CommonLit rather than reproduce, since it remains under copyright. Both stories build tension and unease rather than depicting violence directly, and both are widely taught at this grade for exactly that craft. If you would like to preview either story before your student reads it, contact [\[facilitator name/contact\]](#).

Module 6: The Scarlet Pimpernel: the French Revolution and the guillotine

Where: Week 1 and throughout. The built lessons open directly on "a crowd watches the guillotine" in Paris, 1792, and name the historical Reign of Terror as a period in which "tens of thousands of people, many of them nobles, were executed." The violence is historical framing rather than depicted action, but it is named plainly, not softened.

SUGGESTED FAMILY/STUDENT SCRIPT

Our final module reads Baroness Orczy's *The Scarlet Pimpernel* (1905), set during the French Revolution's Reign of Terror, when public executions by guillotine were a daily reality in Paris. The novel does not depict violence directly, but it names this history plainly as the backdrop for its story about disguise, loyalty, and risking everything for strangers. This is real history taught at the level appropriate for this grade; if you have questions about the historical content, please reach out to [\[facilitator name/contact\]](#).

Module 1 (Gulliver's Travels) has no comparable flag: its content is satirical and comic throughout, with no depicted violence, death, or content requiring advance notice.